



## TLD Joins the TaxiBot Program

**TaxiBot** is a dispatch tow tractor concept developed and patented by IAI.

The dispatch towing (or operational Towing) process consists of moving aircraft from the gate to the runway with towing tractors instead of taxiing by using the jet engines of the aircraft.



The implementation of this technology offers yearly potential savings for the aviation industry of 7 billion USD and would reduce CO2 emissions by approximately 18 millions tons. This program perfectly fits within the TLD innovation strategy focused on developing equipment for more environmental friendly airport operations.



For several years already, TLD had made initial investigation steps on his side on the dispatch tow tractor development. However, the constraints imposed by such operation on the Nose Landing Gear of this A/C as well as the reaction of the pilots were key blocking parameters for this development.

In the meantime, TLD realized that IAI, which was not a tractor manufacturer, had developed some exceptional ideas to overcome these two key points. First formal contacts between TLD and IAI were established in the first quarter of 2009 and a rapid common interest was developed by both parties to work together on this program.

In Munich, on October 7<sup>th</sup>, 2009, TLD and IAI (Israel Aerospace Industries) sealed their exclusive partnership for the development and manufacturing of the **TaxiBot** Tractors by signing their formal agreement.



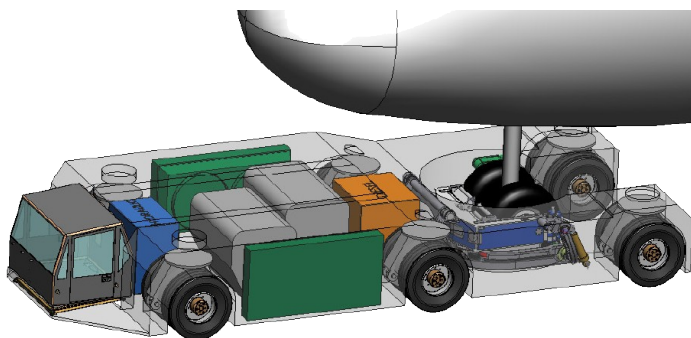
Three of the major innovations that TaxiBot offers are:

- The **Pilot (captain) will remain in Command (PIC)** at all times along the taxiing process, by means of a user friendly Pilot – TaxiBot interface (transparent to the pilot)
- **The stress on the Nose Landing Gear (NLG) will be dramatically reduced** by the Pilot braking by the Main Landing Gear system (as opposed to tractor braking) and the tractor applying a unidirectional stress on the NLG thus reducing considerably the NLG fatigue
- **The TaxiBot tractor will be certified through STC** (Supplement Type Certificate) as though the tractor were a component of the aircraft



AIRBUS has also recently joined the TaxiBot program as an active partner as well as Lufthansa LEOS that has been a long time supporter of the project.

The TaxiBot program is managed by the TLD MTL factory and is run by Nicolas VERMALLE with an engineering team fully dedicated to this program.



The TaxiBot demonstrator (not manufactured by TLD) is currently doing tests with a fully computerized trailer in the UK. The first operational tests on real aircraft with the demonstrator is planned for February 2010 in Toulouse at the AIRBUS factory and IAI & TLD expect to have a TaxiBot prototype ready by the end of 2010.